

Backlog 21 25 Compliance Data Safety

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Backlog 21-25: consumer law, device viability, data, WHS and transport

Researched: 2 October 2026

Scope: online-research backlog items 21-25 only.

Status: source-led operating guidance for a small NSW electronics reuse/refurbishment pilot. It is not a substitute for legal, electrical or WHS advice where licensed work is required.

21. Consumer law and product safety

Consumer guarantees apply to second-hand goods sold by a business

Second-hand goods sold in trade or commerce remain covered by Australian Consumer Law consumer guarantees.

Age, price, disclosed condition and reasonable expectations matter, but a business cannot remove the guarantees with wording such as:

- "no refunds";
- "sold as-is";
- "no warranty expressed or implied".

NSW guidance expressly says consumer-guarantee rights have no fixed expiry date and may continue beyond a business's voluntary written warranty.

Source:

- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/consumer-rights-and-protection/repairs-replacements-and-refunds/ri-ghts-to-a-repair>

Phase 0 policy

A listing can disclose that an item is second-hand, cosmetically worn or has a particular known defect.

It should not imply that statutory rights disappear.

Use wording such as:

Second-hand/refurbished item. Known condition and defects are described above. Australian Consumer Law rights apply.

A separate change-of-mind policy can be more restrictive.

Major versus minor failures

Under ACL:

- a minor problem can generally be remedied by the business, commonly by repair;
- where there is a major problem, the consumer has stronger remedy choices including refund/replacement, subject to the ACL rules.

Do not attempt to encode a universal "7-day warranty" as the complete consumer remedy.

Bendigo benchmark warning

Bendigo E-Waste's public policies have used very short DOA/as-is language. That is not a safe template to copy for an NSW consumer-facing resale business.

The Dubbo project should build its own ACL-compatible policy.

Receipts

For a robust Phase 0 process, issue a receipt/invoice for every sale, even where the statutory minimum would not force one.

Keep:

- legal/business seller name;
- ABN where applicable;
- date;
- description;
- serial/asset ID;
- amount;
- GST treatment where applicable;
- condition/known defects reference.

Critical repair-notice requirement

If Dubbo E-Waste ever accepts customer-owned devices for repair, repair notices become important.

ACCC says a written repair notice must be provided before accepting a product for repair when:

- the product can store user-generated data; or
- refurbished parts may be used; or
- the repairer's practice may be to replace goods with refurbished goods.

For user-data devices, the notice must warn that repair may result in loss of user data.

If refurbished goods/parts may be used, the notice must include this exact prescribed wording:

Goods presented for repair may be replaced by refurbished goods of the same type rather than being repaired. Refurbished parts may be used to repair the goods.

Source:

- <https://www.accc.gov.au/consumers/problem-with-a-product-or-service-you-bought/repair-notice>
- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/consumer-rights-and-protection/repairs-replacements-and-refunds/rights-to-a-repair>

A template has been added to templates/repair-notice.md.

Uncollected repair goods

NSW's Uncollected Goods Act process matters if repair work is added.

Current NSW guidance:

Estimated value	Notice	Minimum notice period	Disposal
rubbish/perishable	none	none	appropriate manner
personal documents	written	28 days	return to author or securely destroy
other goods < \$1,000	verbal or written	14 days	appropriate manner
\$1,000–\$20,000	written	28 days	public auction or fair-value private sale
> \$20,000	Tribunal order	per order	per order

A business can generally recover agreed repair/treatment charges and actual removal/storage/maintenance/insurance/disposal costs, but those costs should not contain a profit component.

Source:

- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/consumer-rights-and-protection/repairs-replacements-and-refunds/uncollected-goods>

Do not simply write "devices left 30 days become ours" into repair terms.

Product recalls

A refurbisher/reseller is part of the supply chain.

Current ACCC guidance says:

- suppliers have safety responsibilities;
- if the business starts a safety recall, it must notify the ACCC within 2 days;
- serious injury, illness or death associated with a supplied consumer product must also be reported within 2 days;
- recall preparation should identify product name/model/serial/batch where relevant and affected customers.

Sources:

- <https://www.productsafety.gov.au/business/recall-an-unsafe-product/tell-the-accc-of-the-recall>
- <https://www.productsafety.gov.au/business/recall-an-unsafe-product/recall-tools-and-guidelines/supplier-checklist-for-conducting-a-recall>
- <https://www.accc.gov.au/business/selling-products-and-services/product-safety-responsibilities>

Phase 0 implication

Keep buyer contact + serial/asset ID linkage for sold electronics.

That is useful not just for accounting but for safety recalls.

NSW second-hand electrical goods

NSW Government says new and second-hand electrical goods are covered by the Gas and Electricity (Consumer Safety) Act 2017.

For a second-hand electrical article, it must have been approved as required when originally sold new.

Sellers/suppliers of second-hand electrical equipment have safety obligations.

Source:

- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/housing-and-construction/safety-home/electrical-safety/buying-and-using-electrical-appliances>

Chargers / power supplies

Phase 0 should avoid:

- unknown/no-name mains chargers;
- chargers with questionable markings;
- damaged mains leads;
- overseas-only plugs/adapters being represented as compliant Australian supplies.

Use known compliant chargers/power supplies and retain model/approval information where practical.

Test-and-tag

SafeWork NSW requires regular inspection/testing of plug-in workplace equipment where it is used in a hostile operating environment such as wet/dusty/corrosive/damage-prone locations.

Source:

- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/resource-library/construction/electrical-services/electrical-risks-at-the-workplace-face-sheet>

This is not evidence of a blanket rule that every second-hand electrical product must be test-and-tagged before retail resale.

The resale safety procedure should instead be based on:

- product category;
- electrical approval/marketing;
- visual inspection;
- functional testing;
- applicable electrical safety law;
- licensed electrical work rules where relevant.

Do not perform mains electrical work that legally requires a licensed electrical worker.

22. Windows/Linux/device resale legality and viability

Windows 11 remains the preferred default

Microsoft's current Windows 11 minimums include:

- compatible 64-bit processor, 1 GHz+, 2+ cores;
- 4 GB RAM;
- 64 GB storage;
- UEFI / Secure Boot capable;
- TPM 2.0;
- DirectX 12 / WDDM 2.0 graphics;
- 720p display >9 inches.

Sources:

- <https://www.microsoft.com/en-AU/windows/windows-11-specifications>
- <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-au/windows/whats-new/windows-11-requirements>

For normal consumer/business resale in late 2026, a genuinely supported Windows 11 machine remains the cleanest default.

Important Windows 10 correction

Normal Windows 10 support ended 14 October 2025.

However Microsoft now offers the consumer Extended Security Updates (ESU) programme in Australia through 12 October 2027.

Current Australian enrollment options shown by Microsoft include:

- no additional cost where eligible settings sync is used;
- 1,000 Microsoft Rewards points;
- AU\$44.95 one-time purchase, including tax.

Source:

- <https://www.microsoft.com/en-AU/windows/end-of-support>

What this changes

The old repo policy effectively treated a non-Windows-11 PC as Linux/vintage/parts only.

That is too absolute.

A better rule is:

Windows 11 compatible is the default commercial target. A Windows 10 22H2 PC may still have a temporary supported consumer pathway through ESU, but the customer must understand that ESU ends 12 October 2027 and enrollment/account conditions apply.

Do not advertise an old PC as long-term supported merely because ESU exists.

Windows licensing for professional refurbishment

Microsoft still operates the Microsoft Authorized Refurbisher (MAR) ecosystem.

Current Microsoft material says MAR is aimed at large refurbishers and provides:

- discounted genuine Windows licences for refurbished devices;
- data wiping/reporting expectations;
- ability for participating MARs to supply licences to Third Party Refurbishers (TPRs).

Source:

- <https://devicepartner.microsoft.com/en-US/communications/comm-resource-center-microsoft-authorized-refurbisher>

Phase 0 implication

Do not assume that finding an existing OEM key automatically settles every refurbishment/licensing scenario.

For low-volume devices:

- preserve/document genuine existing activation where lawful and appropriate;
- don't install pirated/grey-market keys;
- if volume grows, investigate a current Australian MAR/TPR relationship.

Linux

No single Linux distribution is a universal safe answer for unsupported Windows hardware.

For older machines, a Linux resale path is viable only if:

- hardware works reliably;
- chosen distribution is actively supported;
- Wi-Fi/audio/suspend/webcam/etc are tested;
- buyer is clearly told it is Linux;
- the target use case makes sense.

Linux should be a product category, not a way to hide obsolete hardware.

Apple viability

Apple currently defines:

- vintage: more than 5 and less than 7 years since Apple stopped distributing the product;

- obsolete: more than 7 years since Apple stopped distribution.

Hardware service normally ends for obsolete products, with limited exceptions such as some Mac laptop battery-only repair availability up to 10 years subject to parts.

Source:

- <https://support.apple.com/en-au/102772>

This should be checked model by model before accepting older Macs/iPhones/iPads.

Android support

Support periods vary by manufacturer/model.

Example from Google's current policy:

- Pixel 8 and later: 7 years of OS/security/Pixel Drop updates from first US Google Store availability;
- Pixel 6/6a/6 Pro/7/7 Pro/7a/Fold: 5 years;
- Pixel 5a and earlier listed models no longer receive updates.

Source:

- <https://support.google.com/pixelphone/answer/4457705>

Phase 0 should record the actual security support end date for a phone/tablet where it can be verified.

Australian mobile-network viability

ACMA says the 3G shutdown affects all 3G and some 4G devices, particularly where Triple Zero capability is affected.

Users can currently text 3 to 3498 for a free compatibility/status response from their service provider.

Source:

- <https://www.acma.gov.au/3g-network-switch>

Resale rule

Do not list a phone as Australian-network compatible simply because it gets signal on one test SIM.

For older/imported devices:

- identify exact model/submodel;
- check carrier/000 compatibility;
- disclose limitations;
- reject blocked/unusable models for ordinary phone resale.

Battery-health disclosure

No universal Australian statutory percentage threshold for "acceptable used battery health" was found.

Best practice is therefore factual disclosure:

- measured health/cycle count where device exposes it;
- observed runtime/test result;
- any warning/service message;
- whether battery is original/replaced where known.

Do not invent a "minimum legal battery percentage".

23. Data sanitisation and ITAD

NIST has changed

NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 2, published September 2025, supersedes Rev. 1.

Rev. 2 is more program/risk focused and no longer acts mainly as a fixed catalogue of device-specific commands. It places stronger emphasis on:

- a media sanitisation programme;
- information sensitivity;
- appropriate Clear/Purge/Destroy techniques;
- validation/verification;
- cryptographic erase;
- trusted implementations;
- standards such as IEEE 2883.

Sources:

- <https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/88/r2/final>
- <https://www.nist.gov/news-events/news/2025/09/guidelines-media-sanitization-nist-publishes-sp-800-88r2>

Repo correction

Do not describe a generic one-pass wipe as "NIST 800-88 certified".

A better Phase 0 marketing phrase remains:

documented media sanitisation / secure data erasure

and the internal procedure should define the standard/method actually used.

Current ASD/ACSC guidance

ASD's current ISM media guidance gives concrete Australian government sanitisation controls.

Examples:

Magnetic HDD

Current ISM guidance includes:

- overwrite the drive in its entirety at least once with a random pattern;
- read back for verification;
- reset HPA/DCO;
- use ATA Secure Erase in addition to block overwriting for the growth defect table.

Flash / SSD media

Current ISM guidance says non-volatile flash memory is overwritten at least twice with a random pattern followed by read-back verification.

If media cannot be successfully sanitised/verified, it is destroyed before disposal.

Source:

- <https://www.cyber.gov.au/business-government/asds-cyber-security-frameworks/ism/cyber-security-guidelines/guidelines-for-media>

Important distinction

Dubbo E-Waste is not automatically required to apply government-classified-media controls to every consumer disk.

But ISM provides a strong benchmark for commercial clients who want a documented, defensible process.

Apple Silicon / T2 Macs

Apple says Erase All Content and Settings on supported Apple Silicon or T2 Macs renders user data cryptographically inaccessible by obliterating relevant keys in effaceable storage.

Source:

- <https://support.apple.com/en-au/guide/deployment/dep0a819891e/web>

Use supported Apple erase workflows rather than treating every modern Mac SSD as a generic overwrite target.

Android/iPhone

Modern mobile devices generally rely heavily on encrypted storage and platform erase/reset mechanisms.

Operational requirements remain:

- legitimate account/activation-lock removal;
- complete factory erase/reset using manufacturer-supported workflow;
- verification that device activates to clean setup;
- no retained donor/customer account password.

Do not promise forensic destruction based merely on clicking Factory Reset.

Sanitisation certificate fields

A useful sanitisation record should identify:

- business/client;
- asset ID;
- device serial/IMEI;
- storage media type;
- storage media serial where accessible;
- media capacity;
- data classification/instruction if client supplies one;
- chosen sanitisation policy/standard;
- method/command;
- tool and version;
- date/time;
- operator;
- verification/read-back/validation result;
- PASS/FAIL;
- failure reason;
- escalation to destruction if failed;
- final disposition;
- certificate/job number.

A new templates/data-sanitisation-certificate.md file has been added.

Physical destruction provider

Public web research found Shred-X Secure Destruction as a NSW provider offering secure destruction/recycling of electronics, including commercial quantities. The surfaced directory result points to Wetherill Park rather than a Dubbo facility.

Source:

- <https://recyclingnearyou.com.au/material/home/computers/MidWesternNSW>

HP Australia also offers enterprise ITAD with certified data wiping/destruction, but public material does not establish whether a tiny Dubbo pilot is commercially eligible.

Source:

- <https://www.hp.com/au-en/services/workforce-solutions/workforce-computing/it-asset-disposition.html>

Still unresolved

No clearly Dubbo-based public provider with published serialised HDD/SSD destruction pricing was found in this pass.

Get quotes only when the project has client demand.

Privacy Act / NDB

OAIC says most small businesses with annual turnover of \$3 million or less are not covered by the Privacy Act, but important exceptions exist, including some health-service providers, businesses trading in personal information, Commonwealth contractors, TFN recipients and others.

Sources:

- <https://www.oaic.gov.au/privacy/privacy-guidance-for-organisations-and-government-agencies/organisations/small-business>
- <https://www.oaic.gov.au/privacy/notifiable-data-breaches/quick-reference-guide-for-responding-to-data-breaches>

Operational conclusion

Do not market the service as generically "Privacy Act compliant" without checking the actual legal entity/client/data.

Even where the Act does not directly apply, business clients can impose stronger contractual data-security requirements.

Treat all unwiped client media as sensitive.

24. WHS, lithium and workshop safety

Sole trader = PCBU

A self-employed person/sole trader can be a PCBU under NSW WHS law and owes duties to workers and other people affected by the work, including visitors.

Phase 0 is not outside WHS merely because it is small or home based.

NSW Codes of Practice changed in 2026

SafeWork NSW says that from 1 July 2026, s26A of the Work Health and Safety Act makes Codes of Practice the minimum performance standards a PCBU is expected to comply with.

Source:

- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/resource-library/codes-of-practice>

This is important for every risk-control document in the project.

Lithium-ion handling

Current SafeWork NSW guidance says:

- follow manufacturer storage/handling instructions;
- keep batteries cool/dry and away from sunlight/heat/flammables;
- inspect regularly;
- stop using damaged/swollen units;

- use correct chargers;
- do not charge unattended/for long periods;
- isolate damaged batteries;
- use suitable/fire-resistant storage or bags for damaged batteries;
- label damaged-battery packaging;
- follow ADG transport requirements;
- maintain an emergency plan.

Source:

- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/hazards-a-z/lithium-ion-batteries>

Large-quantity threshold

SafeWork NSW notes special emergency-plan notification requirements for workplaces storing/handling/installing 25,000 kg of lithium-ion batteries.

That threshold is irrelevant to Phase 0 volumes, but normal WHS risk duties apply well below it.

FRNSW practical guidance

Fire and Rescue NSW says:

- charge on hard, non-flammable surfaces;
- don't charge while sleeping or away;
- use approved/compatible chargers;
- don't use/charge swollen, leaking, overheated, cracked, dented, punctured or crushed batteries/devices;
- damaged batteries should not go into regular waste/recycling or ordinary battery recycling bins;
- damaged batteries should be kept away from structures/combustibles, with FRNSW guidance referring to at least 3 metres where safe.

Source:

- <https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/shop-charge-and-recycle-safely>
- <https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/what-should-i-do-if-my-battery-is-damaged>

Correction to old cost model

Do not automatically buy a generic "metal battery bin" and assume the problem is solved.

The Phase 0 policy is to reject loose/damaged batteries, minimise storage, supervise charging and have an appropriate emergency/isolation process.

Equipment should follow the actual risk assessment and official guidance.

Dangerous-goods transport

NSW EPA says a dangerous-goods driver or vehicle licence is not required solely for transporting lithium-ion batteries, because they are treated as articles under the ADG Code.

For lithium batteries:

- over 1,000 kg battery mass becomes a placard-load issue;
- controls still apply below licensing/placard thresholds;
- waste transport law can separately apply.

Source:

- <https://www.epa.nsw.gov.au/Your-environment/Dangerous-goods/licensing-training>

Phase 0 will be nowhere near 1,000 kg.

This does not mean damaged batteries can be casually placed loose in a car.

Workplace electrical equipment

Where workshop plug-in equipment is used in a hostile operating environment, SafeWork NSW requires regular inspection/testing by a competent person and RCD controls where applicable.

Source:

- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/resource-library/construction/electrical-services/electrical-risks-at-the-workplace-fact-sheet>

A damp/mould-affected shed is therefore a particularly poor place to operate electrical test equipment until the premises issue is resolved.

CRTs

The existing Phase 0 CRT refusal remains sensible.

Practical distinction:

- intact CRT equipment can be managed as e-waste;
- breaking/crushing CRT glass creates materially greater lead/handling risk.

Do not dismantle CRTs casually at home.

Solder / lead / fumes

Electronics repair can expose workers to solder fumes and, depending on material, lead/other contaminants.

Risk control should prioritise elimination/substitution/engineering controls such as local exhaust ventilation where relevant, not simply PPE.

Phase 0 should avoid building a high-volume board-rework/dismantling line in the home shed.

Printer toner

No strong current NSW-specific public source surfaced that creates a special licence for ordinary toner handling at this tiny scale.

Practical rule remains:

- don't accept loose/spilled toner;
- keep cartridges contained;
- follow manufacturer SDS information;
- pre-approve printers.

25. Transport and postage

Australia Post lithium limits

Australia Post's current dangerous/restricted-items guidance says it can carry lithium batteries only within specified limits, including:

- lithium-ion cell: 20 Wh max per cell;
- lithium-ion battery: 100 Wh max per battery.

For international or domestic air carriage:

- batteries/cells must be installed in the device;
- maximum two batteries or four individual cells;
- packaging requirements apply.

Australia Post prohibits:

- recalled lithium batteries;
- damaged batteries;
- non-conforming batteries.

Source:

- <https://auspost.com.au/business/shipping/shipping-guidelines/dangerous-prohibited-items>

Packaging rule

Australia Post says:

- device must be protected from accidental activation;
- strong internal/external packaging is required;
- lithium batteries must not be packed by themselves or simply alongside a device for the services described.

Phase 0 shipping policy

1. Never post swollen/damaged/recalled lithium batteries or devices containing them.
2. Identify battery Wh rating before shipping.
3. Default to device-with-battery-installed where permitted.
4. Use rigid protective packaging and prevent device movement/activation.
5. Re-check the carrier rules for each shipment, especially international.

6. Do not assume a courier follows Australia Post rules; every carrier has its own dangerous-goods acceptance conditions.

High-value shipping

For every shipment track:

- device serial/asset ID;
- photos before packing;
- packaging method;
- tracking number;
- declared/covered value;
- signature option where used;
- dispatch date;
- delivery result.

Shipping-damage/return risk must be in the margin model.

Local delivery versus postage

For large monitors/TVs, local pickup/delivery is likely much more defensible during the pilot than courier freight because:

- high breakage risk;
- oversize freight;
- difficult claims;
- low margin relative to freight.

No national TV-shipping policy should be adopted without testing packaging and carrier cost on actual models.

Operating changes from 21-25

1. Add the ACL repair notice before accepting any customer repair.
2. Add an uncollected-goods process; never rely on "30 days = ours".
3. Keep buyer/serial records sufficient to run a recall.
4. Do not use "no warranty/as-is" as a substitute for ACL rights.
5. Keep Windows 11 as default, but recognise Windows 10 consumer ESU through 12 Oct 2027.
6. Investigate MAR/TPR licensing only if Windows-refurb volume becomes meaningful.
7. Use NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 2 / ASD guidance as programme standards, not marketing buzzwords.
8. Treat modern Apple erase as cryptographic sanitisation where Apple documents it.
9. Keep Privacy Act claims conditional; small-business exemption has exceptions.
10. Update WHS documents for NSW's 1 July 2026 Code of Practice change.
11. Do not accept damaged lithium in Phase 0.
12. Never post damaged/recalled lithium batteries.

13. Replace the generic "metal battery bin" assumption with risk-assessed charging/isolation controls.

Primary sources

Consumer/product

- <https://www.accc.gov.au/consumers/problem-with-a-product-or-service-you-bought/repair-notice>
- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/consumer-rights-and-protection/repairs-replacements-and-refunds/rights-to-a-repair>
- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/legal-and-justice/consumer-rights-and-protection/repairs-replacements-and-refunds/uncollected-goods>
- <https://www.productsafety.gov.au/business/recall-an-unsafe-product/tell-the-accc-of-the-recall>
- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/housing-and-construction/safety-home/electrical-safety/buying-and-using-electrical-appliances>

Devices/OS

- <https://www.microsoft.com/en-AU/windows/windows-11-specifications>
- <https://www.microsoft.com/en-AU/windows/end-of-support>
- <https://devicepartner.microsoft.com/en-US/communications/comm-resource-center-microsoft-authorized-refurbisher>
- <https://support.apple.com/en-au/102772>
- <https://support.google.com/pixelphone/answer/4457705>
- <https://www.acma.gov.au/3g-network-switch>

Data

- <https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/88/r2/final>
- <https://www.cyber.gov.au/business-government/asds-cyber-security-frameworks/ism/cyber-security-guidelines/guidelines-for-media>
- <https://support.apple.com/en-au/guide/deployment/dep0a819891e/web>
- <https://www.oaic.gov.au/privacy/privacy-guidance-for-organisations-and-government-agencies/organisations/small-business>

WHS/transport

- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/resource-library/codes-of-practice>
- <https://www.safework.nsw.gov.au/hazards-a-z/lithium-ion-batteries>
- <https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/shop-charge-and-recycle-safely>
- <https://www.epa.nsw.gov.au/Your-environment/Dangerous-goods/licensing-training>
- <https://auspost.com.au/business/shipping/shipping-guidelines/dangerous-prohibited-items>

Supplementary compliance/tooling findings — 2 October 2026

EESS / RCM nuance for second-hand equipment

The Electrical Equipment Safety System (EESS) states that the EESS framework itself does not apply to second-hand electrical equipment that was previously sold in Australia and was compliant when originally offered for sale.

That is important: ordinary resale of legitimately Australian-market second-hand equipment does not automatically turn Dubbo E-Waste into an EESS Responsible Supplier.

However:

- individual state/territory second-hand electrical safety requirements still apply;
- if the business imports or manufactures new in-scope electrical equipment, Responsible Supplier / registration / RCM obligations can arise;
- suppliers of new in-scope equipment should source compliant/registered products and observe RCM requirements.

Sources:

- <https://www.eess.gov.au/equipment/second-hand-electrical-equipment/>
- <https://www.eess.gov.au/responsible-suppliers/>
- <https://www.eess.gov.au/equipment/electrical-equipment-safety-system/>

Phase 0 implication

Prefer original/compliant Australian chargers and power supplies. Do not import generic mains chargers and assume second-hand-device rules cover them.

Electrical repair licensing

NSW Government says a licence/certificate is required to do electrical wiring work, regardless of cost or location.

Source:

- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/business-and-economy/licences-and-credentials/electrical-work-licences>

That does not mean every low-voltage computer repair is licensed electrical wiring work.

It does mean the project should draw a firm boundary around mains wiring/electrical work and use an appropriately licensed person where the legal definition is triggered.

Practical sanitisation tooling

nwipe

Current nwipe documentation says recent releases, including v0.43, add native secure-erase support for ATA SSDs and NVMe devices where the hardware/firmware supports it.

The project's tool policy can therefore distinguish between:

- magnetic-drive overwrite/verification;
- drive-native ATA secure erase;

- NVMe native erase/sanitize capabilities.

Source:

- <https://github.com/martijnvanbrummelen/nwipe>

nvme-cli

NVM Express documentation describes the NVMe Sanitize command as supporting operations including:

- block erase;
- cryptographic erase;
- overwrite;

with the purpose of making prior user data unrecoverable from media, cache and relevant overprovisioned areas where the controller implements the feature.

Sources:

- <https://nvmexpress.org/resources/nvm-express-base-specification/>
- <https://github.com/linux-nvme/nvme-cli>

Operational warning

Do not turn tool availability into a compliance claim.

For every medium:

1. detect capabilities;
2. select the documented appropriate method;
3. capture tool/version and result;
4. verify/validate;
5. if sanitisation cannot be successfully completed/verified, route the medium to destruction.

Destructive firmware commands such as ATA security erase should be used only under a controlled SOP by someone who understands the device and risks.

Lithium fire response / extinguishers

Fire and Rescue NSW's current guidance is more nuanced than "buy extinguisher type X".

For a small overheating phone/tablet, if safe, FRNSW guidance includes disconnecting power and moving it away from structures/combustibles. Small lithium-ion devices may be cooled with clean water where safe, and water may be used on a small lithium-ion fire where there is no energised-electrical hazard.

FRNSW also warns that dry-chemical-powder or CO₂ extinguishers may help stop fire spread but are unlikely to fully extinguish a lithium-ion cell fire; reignition remains a risk and 000 should be called.

Sources:

- <https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/what-should-i-do-if-my-battery-is-damaged>

- <https://www.fire.nsw.gov.au/fire-safety/home-fire-safety/battery-and-charging-safety/shop-charge-and-recycle-safely>

Phase 0 conclusion

Do not specify one extinguisher as "the lithium solution".

Final fire equipment/detection should follow:

- the actual premises risk assessment;
- insurer requirements;
- FRNSW guidance;
- electrical risks present in the workspace.

No authoritative source found in this pass justified a universal smoke-vs-heat detector answer for this exact shed.

Courier-specific lithium restrictions

Australia Post is not the only rule set.

Sendle's current dangerous-goods policy is notably restrictive for electronics with lithium batteries. Its public policy allows only defined small quantities/conditions and does not provide a safe basis for assuming old phones being sent for recycling are acceptable. International lithium-ion carriage is restricted.

Source:

- <https://try.sendle.com/en-au/dangerous-goods>

Shipping rule

Before booking each courier:

- check that carrier's current lithium/device policy;
- confirm whether used/refurbished battery devices are eligible;
- retain battery Wh/model details;
- never ship damaged/swollen/recalled batteries;
- do not assume Australia Post acceptance means another courier accepts the parcel.

StarTrack/other carriers should be treated as carrier-confirmation required until their current service-specific terms are checked at booking.